Acquisition Paper

CS 4010 – Intro to Computer Law

Aesha Shah

Introduction

In business and technology markets, acquisitions are a common method for companies to expand their capabilities and strengthen their strategic position. An acquisition occurs when one company purchases another (commonly referred to as an acquisition's target) and assumes control over its products, intellectual property, employees, and long-term direction. These transactions usually involve extensive due diligence, financial negotiations, and legal review, since the acquiring company must evaluate the target's assets, liabilities, and integration risks. When executed successfully, an acquisition can reshape the acquiring company's product ecosystem and open new paths for growth.

Atlassian and Miro

This broader context can be applied to two such companies, Atlassian and Miro. Atlassian is a global software company known for its suite of tools that support structured collaboration and project execution, including Jira, Confluence, Bitbucket, and Trello. These products help teams organize work, document knowledge, and track progress across complex projects. Atlassian is most often used by software engineers and product managers. Miro occupies a different part of the collaboration space. Its platform centers on visual thinking, real-time ideation, and shared whiteboarding. It is widely used for early-stage product development, cross-functional workshops, and design activities that require rapid, creative interaction. Miro supports product designers and non-technical groups that need visual thinking.

Although the two companies approach collaboration from different angles, they serve many of the same teams within a modern organization. A typical workflow often begins in a whiteboard tool like Miro, where ideas and initial concepts are drafted. Those ideas are then translated into tasks, requirements, and documentation within Atlassian tools. This natural progression shows how Atlassian's acquisition of Miro would not only align with how teams already work but also give Atlassian a more complete role in the entire lifecycle of collaboration. Acquiring Miro would strategically strengthen Atlassian's collaboration ecosystem by integrating visual, real-time whiteboarding with Atlassian's project management and productivity tools. The combination creates a seamless platform for distributed teams to ideate, plan, and execute, reinforcing Atlassian's mission to "unleash the potential of every team."

Products and Trends

Before examining the potential benefits of the acquisition in more detail, it is helpful to understand why there is a growing need for integrated collaboration solutions and how integrating Miro into Atlassian's product ecosystem would address this gap.

Atlassian's Products

Atlassian's tools follow the path most teams take as a project develops. Each product supports a different step, and together they form a structured sequence:

- Confluence – where teams store early notes, research, and drafts of requirements. It helps organize scattered information into something clearer, giving everyone the background they need before planning starts.
- After ideas are defined, they are moved to Jira – teams turn ideas into epics, stories, and tasks, and Jira keeps track of priorities, deadlines, and progress.
- Bitbucket – used once engineers begin writing code. It manages repositories, pull requests, and code reviews. By linking commits back to Jira issues, it ties the work developers do to the original plan.
- Trello – supports teams that need a simpler system. Its boards and lists work well for smaller projects or non-technical groups that benefit from a more visual, flexible tool.

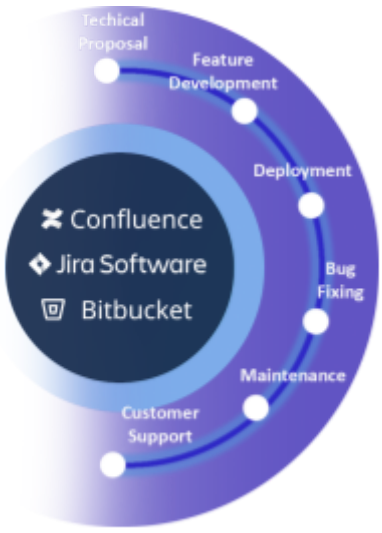


Image citation provided in References section

However, even with these tools, there is a clear gap at the beginning of the workflow. Although Confluence provides a platform to store initial drafts, early brainstorming usually happens in unstructured spaces (like physical and digital whiteboards, sticky notes, or even basic document files), and that work does not naturally connect to Atlassian's system. As a result, teams often lose context or repeat work when moving from ideas to formal planning.

Remote & Hybrid Work Trends

Over the past decade, particularly as an outcome of the COVID-19 pandemic, workplace practices have shifted significantly. More companies are adopting remote-first and/or hybrid work models, where employees split their time between offices and home or work entirely remotely. As these models become more prevalent, distributed teams often spend more time coordinating ideas and brainstorming digitally than in physical meetings. Rather than having access to a physical whiteboard or old-school pen and paper, employees are required to use multiple collaboration tools to effectively communicate and draft ideas, which takes up time that could be better spent behind deeper ideation and development.

The demand for software that can support both creative and operational aspects of teamwork is growing steadily, making it a strategic priority for companies to invest in integrated (and streamlined) digital collaboration systems. According to a market-analysis report, the collaborative whiteboard software market was estimated at $2.16 billion in 2023 and is expected to reach $4.9 billion by 2028, a direct effect of the rising demand for real-time collaboration in remote and hybrid work environments.
Given these trends: digital workspaces, remote/hybrid models, and the need for integrated collaboration, there is a strong strategic incentive for a company like Atlassian to consider developing (which is discussed in a later section of this paper) or acquiring a whiteboarding tool.

Miro's Integration

Miro fills the ideation gap left by Atlassian's existing suite by providing a shared visual space for early thinking. Its online whiteboard supports brainstorming, mapping user journeys, sketching flows, and running workshops (tasks that benefit from spatial, visual, and flexible canvases).

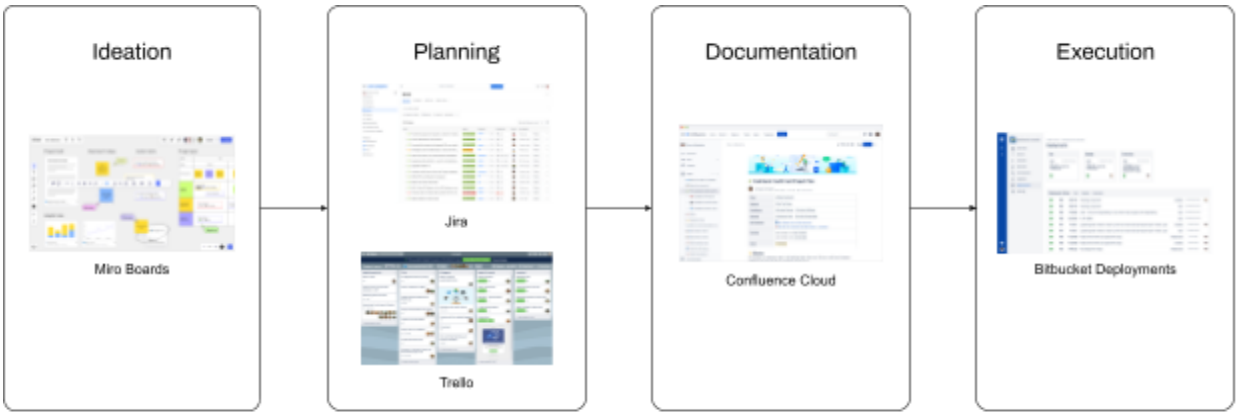


Image citations provided in References section

Once ideas become more concrete, teams can move them into Confluence, Jira, or Trello without starting from scratch, preserving context, reducing duplication, and streamlining workflow. This continuity ensures that early-stage creative work is not siloed but flows into structured planning and execution. By bridging the ideation-to-execution gap, Miro complements Atlassian's tools and provides a more end-to-end collaboration experience.

Market Opportunity & Competitive Positioning

Atlassian has a strong market position, reporting over $5.2 billion in annual revenue and more than $1.4 billion in free cash flow in fiscal year 2025. Its cloud-based offerings account for the majority of revenue, and further expansion in this area could drive additional growth. It serves over 300,000 organizations worldwide, including numerous Fortune 500 companies, giving it a

solid reputation and a broad customer base that is well-positioned to adopt newly integrated products.

Miro has also achieved significant adoption with recent data reporting the platform is utilized by over 90 million users across more than 250,000 organizations globally. By acquiring Miro, Atlassian would gain access to customers with design, creative, and cross-functional teams that may not currently use Atlassian tools but rely heavily on visual collaboration platforms. Miro users could be introduced to Atlassian's broader suite (Jira, Confluence, Bitbucket, Trello), hypothetically boosting revenue per user and overall customer lifetime value.

By integrating Miro into its existing suite, Atlassian would also gain a competitive advantage over other collaboration ecosystems such as Microsoft Teams + Whiteboard, Google Workspace + Jamboard, and FigJam + Figma. Unlike these competitors, which often excel only within their own narrow workflows, Atlassian + Miro can offer a full end-to-end solution spanning ideation, planning, documentation, project tracking, and code execution.

Competitive Ecosystems



Microsoft Teams + Whiteboard



Google Workspace + Jamboard



Figma + FigJam

Image citations provided in References section

Connection Potential

Seamless Workflow

With Miro embedded into Atlassian's ecosystem, teams could start projects using Miro's whiteboard for ideation, brainstorming, user-journey mapping, or workshop sessions. As ideas solidify, Miro boards could be embedded directly into Atlassian products such as Jira or Confluence.

Because of real-time integration, any changes made on the Miro board would sync to Jira issues or Confluence docs, ensuring that team members always work from the latest version. This reduces redundant effort, minimizes context-switching, and preserves historical context from inception through execution.

Imagine a product team sketching a user flow on Miro, then converting that to epics and stories in Jira with a few clicks, assigning tasks to engineers, linking code repositories in Bitbucket, and tracking progress, all while keeping original visual context intact. This unified pipeline could drastically improve collaboration across design, product, and engineering teams, for example:

- Ideation and user-story mapping in Miro, then into Jira for backlog refinement.
- Use Miro boards for retrospectives, team reviews, and post-mortems; attach results to project docs in Confluence.

Expanding Ecosystem & Marketplace Opportunities

Acquiring Miro could also expand the reach and potential of the existing Atlassian Marketplace. Developers and third-party providers could build templates, plugins, or integrations that combine Miro's whiteboarding capabilities with Atlassian's project and code tools. This would create value not only for end users, but also for the wider developer ecosystem, encouraging creative innovation and enhancing the current marketplace's scope.

Cultural & Organizational Fit

From a cultural and organizational standpoint, Atlassian and Miro share substantial alignment. Both emphasize collaboration, transparency, distributed workforces, and a product-led growth model. Miro's growth and branding, which emphasize visual collaboration, creativity, and remote teamwork, align well with Atlassian's enterprise-scale mission of enabling teams to work together effectively across various regions and time zones.

Because of this cultural fit, integration after acquisition could be smoother, with fewer clashes in management philosophy, workflow style, or company values. This alignment would facilitate cross-team collaboration, ease communication, and support a unified vision for collaboration software.

Potential Product Overlap

It is important to note a potential conflict to this acquisition, Atlassian already has a whiteboarding offering in beta (Atlassian Whiteboards). However, instead of maintaining multiple whiteboarding products, Atlassian could, after acquiring Miro, designate Miro as the flagship whiteboarding solution. Atlassian Whiteboards (beta) could be phased out or merged, and key features integrated into Miro to avoid redundancy and confusion.

This strategic consolidation allows Atlassian to focus resources on delivering a fully-developed whiteboarding experience, while streamlining product offerings and minimizing overlap. It also avoids fragmenting the user base between two overlapping tools, instead allowing Atlassian to focus time and monetary investments towards new products.

Due Diligence

Before moving forward with an acquisition, Atlassian would need to conduct due diligence on Miro to understand any risks involved and make sure the company's assets are accurately represented. One of the most important areas of review would be intellectual property, since Miro is a software platform. Atlassian would need to confirm that Miro owns the rights to its codebase, that any open-source components are properly licensed, and that there are no disputes or claims involving patents, trademarks, or proprietary technology. This prevents future legal issues and ensures Atlassian can safely build on top of Miro's existing product.

Another key part of due diligence would involve data privacy and security. Miro handles large volumes of user-generated content, including drawings, diagrams, and sensitive project information, so Atlassian would need to verify that Miro complies with major privacy regulations like GDPR and CCPA. They would also look at security certifications, incident history, and internal policies for handling personally identifiable information. Any major issues here could impact customer trust or create regulatory liabilities, so understanding Miro's security posture is critical.

Financial due diligence would also play an important role. Atlassian would need to analyze Miro's revenue, growth rate, expenses, and debt to confirm that the company is financially healthy and that the purchase price matches the company's value. Since Miro has raised venture capital, Atlassian would also need to review investor agreements, liquidation preferences, and any other obligations that could affect the cost or structure of the deal.

Conclusion

In conclusion, acquiring Miro would represent a strategically sound decision for Atlassian. By combining Miro's visual, real-time whiteboarding capabilities with Atlassian's robust project management, documentation, and development tools, the company could deliver a full-cycle collaboration ecosystem. This integration would expand Atlassian's total addressable market into new user segments (design, creative, cross-functional teams), strengthen competitive positioning against all-in-one platforms (e.g. Google, Microsoft, Figma, etc.), and deliver operational efficiencies and enhanced workflows for distributed teams. Culturally and organizationally, the two companies are aligned, which should ease post-acquisition integration. While there may be overlap with existing whiteboarding efforts within Atlassian's product line, consolidating under Miro would establish a well-developed product and allow for further investment in other areas within Atlassian's scope.

Ultimately, Atlassian + Miro can create a seamless, end-to-end digital teamwork ecosystem that supports teams from the spark of an idea to final delivery, enabling greater productivity, innovation, and long-term growth.

References

Atlassian. (2025, October 3). *Use Rovo to search for answers: Confluence Cloud*. Atlassian Support. https://support.atlassian.com/confluence-cloud/docs/use-atlassian-intelligence-to-search-for-answers/

Atlassian. (n.d.). *Products*. https://www.atlassian.com/software

Cannon-Brookes, M. (2025, August 8). *Our Q4 FY25 letter to shareholders*. Work Life by Atlassian. https://www.atlassian.com/blog/announcements/shareholder-letter-q4fy25?utm_source=chatgpt.com

A Collaborative Digital Whiteboard for teams: Miro. https://miro.com/. (n.d.). https://miro.com/whiteboard/

DSS - Atlassian Plugins & Ecosystem Development. DS SOLUTION, INC. (2023, August 29). https://www.dssolution.jp/ja/atlassian-en/

Figjam for iPad. Figma Learn - Help Center. (n.d.). https://help.figma.com/hc/en-us/articles/4502073572247-FigJam-for-iPad

Google Workspace updates: Join or start a meeting directly from Jamboard on the web to kickstart collaboration. Workspace Updates Blog. (2022, October 11). https://workspaceupdates.googleblog.com/2022/10/start-meetings-from-jamboard-on-web.html

Hermann, J., & Gupta, A. (2023, September 24). *How Miro Grows: Tactical lessons from the $17.5B whiteboard* . How Miro Grows: Tactical Lessons From The $17.5B Whiteboard . https://www.howtheygrow.co/p/how-miro-grows?utm_source=chatgpt.com

Joe Binz, M. C.-B. (2025, June 4). *Our Q3 FY25 letter to shareholders*. Work Life by Atlassian. https://www.atlassian.com/blog/announcements/shareholder-letter-q3fy25

Meyer, D. (2024, May 2). *Welcome to the next era of jira*. Work Life by Atlassian. https://www.atlassian.com/blog/announcements/the-next-era-of-jira

Microsoft. Microsoft Support. (n.d.). https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/office/use-whiteboard-in-a-teams-meeting-26f87802-b37f-4af0-806d-af79fbfb8ae6

Miro Products, Platform Overview. Miro. (n.d.). https://miro.com/products/platform-overview/

MordorIntel. (2025, October 10). *Collaborative Whiteboard Software Market Report: Industry Analysis, Size & Growth Trends*. Mordor Intelligence. https://www.mordorintelligence.com/industry-reports/collaborative-whiteboard-software-market

Press@Miro.com. (2025, May 7). *Miro Launches Solution Partner Program to Accelerate Enterprise Innovation and collaboration*. Global Press Release & Newswire Distribution Services. https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20250507080020/en/Miro-Launches-Solution-Partner-Program-to-Accelerate-Enterprise-Innovation-and-Collaboration

Ryall, M. (2024, November 6). *Introducing bitbucket deployments: Confidence to release early and often*. Work Life by Atlassian. https://www.atlassian.com/blog/bitbucket/introducing-bitbucket-deployments

Trello. (2024, January 31). *How to use Trello to manage and inspire your team*. Work Life by Atlassian. https://www.atlassian.com/blog/trello/trello-manage-team